

INDIA TODAY

www.indiatoday.com

Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie

Chief Executive Officer: Ashish Bagga

Editor: Prabhu Chawla

Managing Editors: Raj Chengappa, Dilip Bobb, Shankar Aiyar

Editor-at-Large: S. Prasannarajan, Executive Editor: Kaveree Bamzai

Deputy Editors: Farzand Ahmed, Damayanti Datta,

Ashok K. Damodaran, Sharda Ugra

Senior Editors: Saurabh Shukla, MUMBAI: Malini Bhupta,

HYDERABAD: Amarnath K. Menon

Photo Editor: Bandep Singh

Art Editor: Sapnaa Kapoor

Associate Editors: S. Sahaya Ranjit, Priya Sahgal, Sandeep Unnithan,

AMMADABAD: Uday Mahurkar, CHANDIGARH: Ramesh Vinayak,

LUCKNOW: Subhash Mishra

Assistant Editors: Nivedita Mukherjee,

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: M.G. Radhakrishnan, KOLKATA: Elora Sen

Special Correspondents: Shafi Rahman, JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar,

BANGALORE: Nirmala Ravindran

Principal Correspondents: Mihir Srivastava, Nandini Vaish,

BANGALORE: Stephen David, Swagata Sen; BHOPAL: Ambresh Mishra,

MUMBAI: Aditi Pai, PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava

Copy Desk: Shalini S. Sharma (Assistant Editor), Kaushik Deka, Rahul Kumar,

Sangram Keshari Parhi, Shijith P.K., Shilpi, Priyanka Sood,

Shveta Srivastava, Rahul Tewari, Priya Verma, Anju Yadav

Photo Department: Hemant Chawla, Sipra Das, Yasbanti Negi,

Ravi Sahani, Vikram Sharma, Reuben Singh,

AMMADABAD: Shailesh Raval, CHENNAI: H.K. Rajashekar,

MUMBAI: Mandar Deodhar, Shriya Patil, Bhaskar Paul,

Rashmi Hajela (Chief Photo Researcher)

Infographics and Illustrations: Saurabh Singh

Art Department: Madhu Bhaskar (Art Director), Ranjita Bhattacharji,

Vandana Nayar, Jyoti K. Singh (Deputy Art Directors), Rashmi Ajmani Girdhar,

Vipin Gupta, Pushvinder Kaur

Production Department: Surinder Hastu (Chief of Production),

Harish Aggarwal, Naveen Gupta

Publishing Director: Malcolm D. Mistry

Associate Publishers: Manoj Sharma (Impact),

Umesh Kumar (Marketing)

IMPACT TEAM

General Managers: Kaustav Chatterjee (East), V. Somasundaram (Chennai),

Preeti Kohli (North), Jitendra Lad (West)

Deputy General Manager: Viswanath C.V. (Bangalore)

Consumer Marketing Services: Poonam Sangha, Senior General Manager

Sales and Operations: Vivek Gaur, Executive Director

D.V.S. Rama Rao, Senior General Manager

Vinod Das, General Manager (Sales)

C.V. Vaidyalingam, Senior General Manager (South)

Rajesh Menon, General Manager (West)

Rajeev Gandhi, Deputy General Manager (East)

S. Sridhar, General Manager (Operations)



Volume XXXIII Number 28; For the week July 8-14, 2006, released on July 7

Editorial Office Living Media India Ltd. F-14/15, Connaught Place New Delhi 110001. Phones: 23315801-4;

Fax: 23316180; Cable: Livmedia, New Delhi

Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (U.P.) 201301;

Phones: Toll-free number: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines); (95120) 2479900 from Delhi and

Faridabad; (0120) 2479900 from Rest of India (Monday-Friday, 10 a.m.-6 p.m.); Fax: (0120) 4078080;

e-mail: arecare@indiatoday.com; Mumbai: 022-24444426, Fax: 24444358; Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to

General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, 201 Computer House, F-14, Middle Circle, Connaught Place,

New Delhi • Regd. Office: K-9 Connaught Circus, New Delhi 110001 • Impact Offices: Trade Centre, 2nd Floor,

Kamala City, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai 400013; Phone: 24983355; Fax: 24982266 • Hamilton

House, 1-A, Connaught Place, New Delhi 110001; Phone: 23352233; Fax: 23327330 • 98-A, Dr. Radhakrishnan Sala,

2nd Floor, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004; Phones: 28478526-41; Telex: 041-6177 Into In; Fax: 28472178; Cable:

Livmedia Chennai • 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones:

22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; Cable: Livmedia, Bangalore • 52, Jawaharalal Nehru Road,

4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; Cable: Livmedia, Kolkata • 6-3-8857/8,

Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23410100, 23402481, 23410982, 23411498;

Fax: 23403484 • 39/1045, Karakkatt Road, Kochi 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058; Fax: 2377059

• 2/C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchsathi, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006;

Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293

Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is

prohibited. Printed and published by Ashish Bagga on behalf of Living Media India Ltd. Printed at Thomson Press

India Ltd., 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007 (Haryana);

A-9, Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, district Kancheepuram-603209, (Tamil Nadu); and

at Plot No. 5-5A, TTC Industrial Area, Thane, Belapur Road, Airoli, Navi Mumbai-400708, (Maharashtra).

Published at K-9, Connaught Circus, New Delhi-110001.

INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

Recently a friend sent me a video clip of a 12-year-old Canadian girl called Severn Suzuki who along with three friends raised their own money to travel thousands of miles to the 1992 Earth Summit in Rio where she made a heart-wrenching speech. She said she had come to Rio, "to tell you adults you must change your ways. Coming here today, I have no hidden agenda. I am fighting for my future."

I can do no better than to quote her, "I'm only a child and I don't have all the solutions, but I want you to realise, neither do you. You don't know how to fix the holes in our ozone layer; you don't know how to bring salmon back up a dead stream; you don't know how to bring back an animal now extinct; and you can't bring back forests that once grew where there is now desert. If you don't know how to fix it, please stop breaking it!"

Her plaintive cry 16 years ago has largely gone unheard. So far the world's response to climate change has been inadequate and uneven. Developed nations have been slow to adhere to norms underlined by the 1997 Kyoto Protocol which sought worldwide cuts in carbon emissions. The United States with per capita carbon dioxide emission levels of 20 metric tonne—as opposed to the global average of 4.25 tonne and India's CO₂ emissions are 1 metric tonne—has even pulled out of Kyoto.

It might seem unfair for countries like India to be pressurised to adhere to global standards that the worst offenders pay no attention to. This is not the time for finger-pointing but for India to provide the moral leadership in spite of being a developing country. The National Action Plan on Climate Change, released by the prime minister on June 30, recognises that India is, in fact, ideally placed to make the switch from fossil fuels to alternative sources of energy in the most economical and effective manner possible.

Our cover story this week is about what India can do to become a leader in the international movement to counter the effects of global warming. We also offer 50 ways that can make a difference to India's green campaign, where small changes make big difference, whether it means reverting to wearing traditional fabrics suitable for our climate which will reduce the need for air-conditioning, switching off computers and geysers or generally being conscious about the carbon footprint that we leave on our surroundings.

Our story has been written by Managing Editor Raj Chengappa, who has worked the environment beat for the better part of 25 years and is one of the non-governmental members on the Prime Minister's Council on Climate Change.

India must do all it can to set the agenda on the best practices to counter climate change and also put pressure on other nations to respond in equal measure. After all, no matter which country we live in, the ultimate reality is that this planet is the only home that mankind will ever have.

Aroon Purie
(Aroon Purie)